

Hathorn Dashboard

The monthly financial statement and advisory platform for Hathorn Advisory Group. A bookkeeper uploads the close, an automated gate refuses anything that does not tie, an advisor writes the explanation and approves it, and the client reads a branded statement in their own portal.

OVERVIEW · WORKFLOW · SCREEN-BY-SCREEN GUIDE

01

Demo access

Sign in

luis-metric-decrease-score.trycloudflare.com

ROLE	EMAIL	LANDS ON
Admin	regen@hathornadvisorygroup.com	Today
Advisor	jeremiah@hathornadvisorygroup.com	Today
Bookkeeper	books@hathornadvisorygroup.com	Upload
Client	owner@northbridge.example	Portal

Password for every account: ledger2026

This is a demonstration environment with four invented client businesses. Judge the shape of the work and the language, not the figures. Nothing here touches a real client's books. The address above belongs to a temporary demo host and changes when the demo is restarted — ask Regen for the current one if it does not open.

Start as the advisor. Sign in as Jeremiah. That is the seat the product is designed around, and the whole month runs through it.

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What this is

Clients of the firm never open QuickBooks. As far as they are concerned, this platform *is* the books: one statement a month, branded to them, with the explanation written by their advisor.

Around that sits the work a reporting tool cannot do — which of the firm's clients needs attention this month and why, what changed and whether it is timing or operations, the thirteen-week cash position, budget variance, commitments carried forward from prior months, and the close management that gets the numbers ready in the first place.

The product thesis. Anyone can draw the chart. The explanation is what the client is paying for. Every design decision follows from that — the commentary is set as editorial prose with a rule down the left, not as dashboard callout boxes.

57	10	94
SCREENS	INDUSTRY PROFILES	DATABASE TABLES
447		
AUTOMATED CHECKS PASSING		

BUILT ON

Next.js 14 and TypeScript, server-rendered so the financial computation never runs in the browser. SQLite today with a proven Postgres path. Charts are hand-drawn SVG rather than a charting library, because a library would cost us the typography. Sessions are signed cookies with two-factor authentication available and required for staff in production.

The monthly workflow

Five steps, in order, every month, for every client.



A failed check stops the month here. There is no override.

Every figure the client sees is a frozen copy taken at publication.

Later edits to the working ledger cannot change a statement already sent.

- 1 **Upload.** The bookkeeper submits the month's close on the Upload screen — four CSVs as standard (profit & loss, payroll register, receivables ageing, bank balances), with optional files for balance sheet, volume, and budget. QuickBooks can replace the first two files where it is connected.
- 2 **The gate runs automatically.** It checks that the numbers tie: labour against the payroll register, the balance sheet balances, balance-sheet cash agrees with the bank statement, and more depending on the industry. A failure blocks the month — there is no override.
- 3 **The advisor reviews.** On the review screen they see the full statement as the client will, with the gate result beside it. They write the commentary: a number, a cause, an action. An optional draft can be generated from detected signals, and the advisor always edits it.
- 4 **Publish.** One button. The gate is re-run at that moment, and if it passes the statement is frozen — figures, commentary, branding and all — and the client is notified.
- 5 **The client reads it** in their portal, alongside every prior published month. They never see a draft.

CORRECTING A PUBLISHED MONTH

Accountants amend rather than overwrite, and the software works the same way. An **amendment** creates a new version that supersedes the previous one and records why; the original stays live until the replacement is published. A **withdrawal** removes the statement from the portal entirely. Both require a stated reason, and superseded versions are kept permanently — so "what did you send me in June" always has an answer.

- The four states a month moves through

STATE	MEANING
Awaiting	Figures uploaded, gate not yet satisfied.
Gated	A check failed. Blocked from publication until it is fixed.
In review	Everything ties. Waiting on the advisor's commentary and approval.
Published	Frozen and visible to the client. Locked against edits.

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The gate

The single most important control in the system, and the reason a client can trust what they are reading. It is the release authority: nothing reaches a client without passing it, and it is re-run at the moment of publication rather than trusted from a screen the advisor looked at earlier.

CHECK	APPLIES TO
Revenue, cash and receivables present	Every client
Every active business reported	Every client
Margin within a plausible range	Every client
Labour ties to the payroll register, per business	Labour-based businesses
Payroll sits inside direct cost, per business	Restaurants, contractors
Balance sheet balances	Anyone submitting one
Balance-sheet cash agrees with the bank	Anyone submitting one
Occupancy within capacity	Short-term rental
Enrolment within licensed capacity	Childcare
Pass-through identified, management bridge closes	Property management
Fee recovery reported	Property management
Distributions recorded	NIL athlete

Publishing is blocked by more than arithmetic. A month will also refuse to publish with no real commentary on it, with no figures at all, or as an amendment with no stated reason. Softer conditions — not yet reconciled, low confidence, open cleanup items — are shown as warnings the advisor can proceed past deliberately.

05

Who sees what

ROLE	CAN	CANNOT
ADMIN	Everything, plus firm settings, the activity log, storage and backups.	—
ADVISOR	The whole book: review, write commentary, publish, amend, all client dashboards, close, uploads, planning, tax, guidance.	Platform operations.
BOOKKEEPER	Upload closes, work the close checklist, exceptions, reconciliations, documents, integrations.	Advisory screens, the client book, publishing.
CLIENT	Read their own published statements, insights, reports and shared documents. Ask questions on a metric.	See drafts, see another client, change anything.

Every client is a separate tenant, and separation is enforced at the query level rather than by hiding buttons. One firm cannot reach another firm's book even by editing the address bar; there are permanent automated attacks in the test suite that try exactly that on every run.

Screens · Briefing

Where an advisor starts the day. Reached from the top of the left rail.

Today ADVISOR · ADMIN

Answers one question: what needs me this morning?

YOU SEE	A greeting, three counted figures (clients in the book, clients waiting on you, items needing you today), then the single most urgent item with its client, the reason, and one button that takes you to the work. Beneath it, up to three more.
TO USE IT	Read the top item. Press its button. That is the whole design — it is a briefing, not a register.
NOTE	Every figure is counted from the same rows the queue is built from. Nothing here is decorative.

Attention ADVISOR · ADMIN

The entire book ranked by how much advisory attention it needs.

YOU SEE	One row per client with revenue and its movement, net margin, weeks of cash cover, a confidence percentage, open commitments, the loudest reason for concern, and a score from 0 to 100 banded urgent, watch or steady.
TO USE IT	Read down the score column. Tap a reason to expand every reason behind that score. Use Filter and sort to narrow by industry, tag or band — the cohort statistics at the top follow the filter, so you are always comparing like with like. Sort by steepest decline, fastest growth, or weakest evidence.
NOTE	A bare score would be a horoscope, so every score decomposes into named reasons you can disagree with. Metrics with no agreed target are excluded from scoring rather than judged against an invented band.

Ask Hathorn ALL STAFF

A question box over the firm's own data.

TO USE IT	Pick a suggested question or type your own — "which closes are blocked", "what needs attention today". Optionally scope it to one client first.
NOTE	It answers only from what the platform has computed, and refuses to estimate or invent. It cannot change a figure or publish anything.

Screens · Clients

Clients ADVISOR · ADMIN

The roster, arranged by where each engagement has got to.

YOU SEE Every client with their industry, how many businesses and published months they have, their lifecycle stage — discovery, cleanup, alignment, advisory — and shortcuts to their dashboard, engagement record, portal and settings.

TO USE IT **Add a client** to create one. **Manage** opens full settings: businesses, users, goals, branding, integrations.

Dashboard ADVISOR · ADMIN

One client's month in depth. This is the working surface for a call.

CONTROLS Top of the screen: which client, which month, what to compare against, and which business (or consolidated). A confidence badge sits beside them and expands to show how it was arrived at.

VIEWS **Overview** — headline figures and what changed. **Financials** — the profit & loss detail and payroll composition. **Businesses** — the entities side by side. **Cash** — bank, receivables ageing, thirteen-week projection. **Comparison** — the chosen comparison in full. **Alerts** — everything the engine thinks is wrong. **Metrics** — the client's KPIs against agreed targets. **Volume, Position, Management basis, Reports, Settings.**

TO USE IT Set client and month, read Overview, then follow whatever looks wrong into its view. The state of the screen lives in the address, so any view of any month can be pasted into a message and it opens exactly as you left it.

NOTE Two views are deliberately empty in places and say so. **Vendors** needs transaction-level detail that a monthly close does not carry; it arrives with QuickBooks. **Position** disappears when a month has no balance sheet, rather than showing figures nobody should trust.

Client Experience ADVISOR · ADMIN

Curating what each client sees in their portal.

TO USE IT Choose which portal sections are switched on for this client. Publish an insight or a report. Post a question for management, and decide whether they may answer in the portal. Request a document. Then use **Preview as client** to see the result exactly as they will — a green banner reminds you that you are previewing, with **Exit preview** to leave.

Intelligence · Engagement ADVISOR · ADMIN

INTELLIGENCE

Signals, trends and drivers computed across a client's history — what is moving, what is anomalous, what is worth raising.

ENGAGEMENT

The work before advisory begins, in four tabs: **Discovery** (what the client said they need), **Cleanup** (what the books need first), **Alignment** (the targets agreed with them — these are what makes judgement possible later), and **Sessions** (the meeting record).

WHY ALIGNMENT MATTERS

A target recorded here is what lets the platform say a figure is good or bad. Without one it reports the number and explicitly declines to judge it, because an invented benchmark is worse than none.

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Screens · The close

Upload BOOKKEEPER · ADVISOR · ADMIN

Getting a month's figures into the system.

- 1 Choose the client, year and month.
- 2 Attach the four required files: profit & loss by business, payroll register, receivables ageing, bank balances. Attach the optional ones if you have them — balance sheet, volume, budget.
- 3 Submit. The gate runs immediately.
- 4 Read the result. Each check is named and either passes or explains the difference, with the amount. Fix the source data and upload again — there is no limit on re-uploads until the month is published.

Headers are matched automatically where an export uses different names. A published month cannot be overwritten; it must be amended deliberately.

Close BOOKKEEPER · ADVISOR · ADMIN

Managing the month across the whole book.

YOU SEE

Every client for a given month with their checklist progress and anything blocking them.

TO USE IT

Open a client's close run to work its checklist, record manual checks, waive an item with a reason, or reopen a run. It feeds the release but never publishes on its own.

Exceptions · Reconciliations · Documents · Integrations

EXCEPTIONS	One queue of open work across the firm, gathered from reconciliations, documents, variance and close checks. Assignable.
RECONCILIATIONS	Tie-outs computed deterministically. An AI reading can be attached to explain a difference, but it cannot alter a control total — a test asserts exactly that.
DOCUMENTS	Upload source documents; spreadsheets and CSVs are parsed and their figures extracted. Extractions always land as needs review and never post to the ledger by themselves.
INTEGRATIONS	Per client: connect QuickBooks, see every sync attempt and its outcome, and reconnect when a token expires. Payroll stays a file upload — those APIs are partner-gated.

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Screens · Advisory

Planning ADVISOR · ADMIN

Forecasts and scenarios built from the client's own history.

TO USE IT	Create a scenario, set its assumptions, read the projection. Share it to the client's portal when you want them to see it; unshared scenarios stay internal.
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Tax · Guidance ADVISOR · ADMIN

TAX	A tracker for tax issues with the deterministic rules that apply to them. Every analysis is marked as requiring professional review, and citations are checked against known authorities rather than accepted from a model.
GUIDANCE	Technical accounting research with sources attached. Journal entries can be drafted and are validated, but nothing posts to a client's books from here.

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Screens · Firm

FIRM	The firm's own profile, branding and team.
OPS	Integration status, storage and backups, and the activity log — an append-only record of who did what, searchable by person, client and action.
SECURITY	Your own account: enrol two-factor authentication and keep backup codes. Required for staff in production.

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The review screen

Where the advisory work actually happens, and the only place a statement can be published. Reached from Today, from Attention, or from a client's dashboard.

- 1 Read the gate panel.** It states plainly how many checks passed. If any failed, the figures are not trustworthy yet and publishing is impossible — fix the source and re-upload.
- 2 Read the warnings above the story.** Things that do not block publication but that you should know: not yet reconciled, no agreed targets, low confidence.
- 3 Write the story.** Each note has a tone (info, warn, bad), a heading and a body. The heading should carry a number, a cause and an action — "CDS claims lag — \$58.3K (timing)" rather than "revenue down". Save each note as you finish it.
- 4 Optionally draft first. Draft the story** detects signals in the month — revenue swings, hours changes, labour band breaches, aged receivables, cash coverage — and proposes notes from them. It is a starting point; the advisor always edits, and it can never publish.
- 5 Preview.** The statement below the panel is exactly what the client will read.
- 6 Publish to portal.** The gate re-runs, the statement freezes, the client is notified.
- 7 Afterwards** the same screen offers **Amend** (new version, reason required) and **Withdraw** (remove from the portal), with the full version history.

Why the commentary is enforced. A month cannot be published with boilerplate or an empty note. The explanation is the deliverable; the figures are the evidence for it.

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What the client sees

A calm, branded document rather than a dashboard: their mark in the masthead, their two accent colours on rules and charts, and the firm's typography throughout. Sign in as the client to see it, or use **Preview as client** from Client Experience.

SECTION	CONTAINS
Overview	Headline figures for the published month, what changed, anything needing their attention, open questions.
Financials	The full statement — up to ten numbered sections, from headline figures through payroll, volume, cash and collections, balance sheet position, open commitments and business comparison. Sections with no data disappear rather than showing zeros.
Insights	Written pieces the advisor has published to them.
Reports	Monthly advisory reports.
Planning	Only the forecasts explicitly shared with them.
Documents	Documents made visible to them, and anything the firm has requested.

WHAT THEY CAN DO

- Choose the month and the business, and what to compare against.
- Ask a question against a specific metric; the advisor answers and both are kept.
- Download or print the statement as a PDF.
- Three further interactions are switchable per client and **off by default**: answering management questions, uploading requested documents, and the Ask panel.

WHAT THEY CANNOT DO

See a draft or an unpublished month. Change a figure or a note. Build their own analysis or pick arbitrary date ranges. That last one is a deliberate product decision, not a missing feature: the curated story is what the firm is selling, and a client building their own pivot table is a different and worse product.

How the numbers behave

Six rules run through the whole engine. They are worth knowing because they explain things that would otherwise look like bugs.

– A comparison that cannot be trusted is removed, not shown with a caveat

Two figures can both be correct and still not be comparable — a different accounting basis, a different currency, an unpublished basis, or months of very different length. Where that is true the comparison is suppressed and the reason given. A delta nobody should believe is worse present than absent. A softer case: when a client opens a new business mid-year, every consolidated comparison across that month is mixing a two-business figure with a three-business one, so the platform names the business and stops objecting once you scope to a single entity.

– Good and bad follow the metric, not the sign

Overhead falling is good; revenue falling is not. A labour ratio has both a floor and a ceiling — a home-care agency dropping from 68% to 55% is not an improvement, it means hours were not delivered or costs are posting to the wrong account. Range metrics are judged on movement toward the band, and crossing from one side to the other is never an improvement.

– Small movements read as flat

Each metric carries a materiality threshold. Movement below it renders grey and says "flat" rather than being dressed as good or bad news, because colouring a \$200 change green teaches people to ignore the colours.

– Confidence sits beside the figure and never changes it

A badge in the masthead scores the evidence behind the month — close status, tie-out, reconciliation, completeness, freshness — and expands into the reasons. Revenue was what it was regardless of how good the books are; what changes is what is reported next to it, and whether an unsound comparison is shown at all.

– Percentages move in points

A labour ratio going from 78% to 80% is **+2 points**, never "up 2.6%".

– Flows add up; balances do not

Year-to-date adds revenue and payroll, but takes the closing figure for cash and receivables. Summing twelve months of bank balance produces a number that means nothing.

Industry profiles

The platform was built from one home-care client, which made three things look universal that are not: that direct cost equals payroll, that volume means hours, and that receivables are owed by payers. Ten profiles now carry their own opinion about what to measure, which gate checks apply, and what to call things — so a childcare statement never says "hours paid".

PROFILE	DIRECT COST	VOLUME
Home care	Payroll only	Hours
Childcare	Payroll only	Enrolled children
Short-term rental	Property costs	Nights
Property management	Management basis	Nights managed
Professional services	Payroll only	Billable hours
Restaurant	Payroll plus cost of goods	Covers
Contractor	Payroll plus materials	Jobs
Retail	Cost of goods	Orders
NIL athlete	None	Deals
General business	Payroll plus cost of goods	Units

Property management is not short-term rental. A manager's gross bookings flow through their account but are not their revenue — tax goes to the state, the balance is disbursed to owners, and they keep a fee. Book revenue can be five times management revenue. Report the gross figure and the owner thinks the business is enormous; report only the fee and it will not tie to the return. The platform builds the bridge between them and refuses to publish if it does not reconcile.

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Five-minute tour

Sign in as Jeremiah and follow this path.

- 1 Today.** Read the single item at the top. Ask yourself whether it is genuinely what you would do first.
- 2 Attention** in the left rail. Read the scores, then expand a reason on the top client to see the argument behind it.
- Click **Northbridge Home Care** to open its dashboard. Change the month in the top bar and watch the whole statement move with it. Open **Cash** for the thirteen-week projection.
- Back on **Today**, open the item that says a month is **ready to publish**. Read the gate panel, edit a note, and publish it.
- Client Experience** → **Preview as client**. This is the statement the owner reads. Use **Exit preview** to come back.
- Press / anywhere to jump to any screen by name.

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State of the build

Said plainly, because a confident claim about untested work is worse than no claim.

PROVEN BY EXECUTION

447 automated checks pass: 239 covering the full workflow end to end over HTTP, 11 release smoke checks, 168 unit checks across thirteen subsystems, and 29 more proving database-level tenant isolation and that financial totals survive a database migration unchanged. The workflow suite passes on both database engines. Response times sit between 12 and 29 milliseconds on the main screens.

That covers the gate, all the metric arithmetic, every comparison mode, tenant isolation, publishing and amendment, session security, encryption, backups and restore, and how the system behaves under hostile or malformed input.

WRITTEN BUT NOT YET EXERCISED AGAINST THE REAL THING

- **QuickBooks.** Built to Intuit's documented shapes and unit-tested, but never connected to a live company file. The first connection is where we learn whether the report format matches. Until then the bookkeeper uploads files — about ten minutes a month.
- **Email notifications.** Written and switchable; no key has been attached yet.
- **The AI drafting layer.** Every AI feature falls back to deterministic output when no model key is present, and that fallback is what the tests exercise. Worth knowing: the product works with the model switched off entirely.
- **A real client's numbers.** Everything in the demo is invented. The first real close is the most valuable test available and no amount of automated checking substitutes for it.

DELIBERATELY NOT BUILT

Self-service analytics for clients, automatic publishing without a human approving the language, and peer benchmarking against other clients. Each is a considered product decision rather than a gap: the first two would undermine what the firm is selling, and the third needs a signed agreement with every client before it is anything but theatre.

Hathorn Dashboard · platform guide · prepared August 2026 · management-prepared and unaudited demonstration data throughout.